



HISTORY HACK · U.S. HISTORY

Flight Log

Teacher Key & Facilitation Notes

A companion to *To Form a More Perfect Union*

Tennessee U.S. History · 1877–Present

How to fly this workbook

- **Notice first.** At every stop, Spark shows you something real. Write what you actually see — not what you think you're supposed to say.
- **Debrief honestly.** Notetaker's questions rarely have one answer. Give your read and the evidence behind it.
- **The Arc is yours.** You decide whether each milestone moved the country toward its promise or away. Historians disagree too — so defend your call.
- **Use your book.** Every activity points back to a unit you can reread. This log is where *your* thinking lives.

About this key: answers and historians' reads are provided as *one* defensible reading, not the only one. The Arc and closing arguments are deliberately open — assess the quality of the evidence and reasoning, not agreement with a set verdict.

The Nation Turns West — and the Cities Rise

The Rise of Industrialization · 1877–1900 | Standards US.01, US.02, US.03, US.04, US.05, US.06, US.07

[Archive \(J. Troop\)](#) [Spark](#) [Navigator](#)
[Notetaker](#)

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

As America industrialized, the same forces — the railroad, the factory, the open door — meant opportunity for some and loss for others. Whose America was being built, and at whose expense?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories (definitions shown).

homestead	A claim of public land (usually 160 acres) a settler could earn by living on and improving it, under the Homestead Act of 1862.	assimilation	A policy of forcing a people to abandon their own culture and adopt the dominant one.
Jim Crow	State and local laws that enforced racial segregation and stripped Black Americans of rights after Reconstruction.	political machine	An organization (like Tammany Hall) that controlled a city's politics by trading jobs and favors for votes.
Gospel of Wealth	Andrew Carnegie's idea that the rich had a duty to use their fortunes for the public good.	nativism	Hostility toward immigrants and a preference for native-born residents.

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Key (one defensible read)
1	Analyze how the Homestead Act and the transcontinental railroad drove westward settlement, and why the same expansion was opportunity for settlers... Notice: Here's the deal: move onto 160 acres, live there five years, plant something — and the land is yours. Free. Forever. No catch. Except the "empty"... Debrief: Anna and Chaska describe the same acres in opposite terms. Using one detail from each column, explain how the Homestead Act could be a genuine promise and a genuine injustice at the same time.	The Act gave landless immigrants like Anna's family a real chance at ownership impossible in Europe, and the railroad made it reachable. But that 'public' land was taken from Native nations like Chaska's. Strong answers hold both truths without treating them as equal in kind — opportunity for some was built on dispossession of others.
2	Analyze how the reservation system, the Dawes Act, and boarding schools sought to dissolve Native landholding and identity through forced... Notice: New rules at your new school: they hold you down and cut your hair, hand you a brand-new name, and punish you every single time you speak the... Debrief: Reformers called the boarding schools and the Dawes Act a benefit to Native people. Give the intended goal and the actual effect of this assimilation policy.	Intended goal: turn Native people into individual landowning, English-speaking 'citizens' by replacing communal land and culture. Actual effect: it broke up tribal landholding, opened vast 'surplus' land to non-Native buyers, and inflicted deep cultural and personal harm on children and communities.
3	Explain how the Compromise of 1877 ended Reconstruction and enabled Jim Crow, and evaluate the Freedmen's Bureau's intended role through a period... Notice: Picture the refs strolling off the field at halftime — and the other team gets to write the rules for the next eighty years. That's about what... Debrief: The Compromise of 1877 is often described as the 'end of Reconstruction.' Explain what changed for Black Southerners like Isaiah when federal troops withdrew, using the cartoon and Isaiah's column as evidence.	Claim: the withdrawal of federal protection allowed white Southern governments to impose Jim Crow. Evidence: the cartoon shows the Bureau as the force holding back white violence; Isaiah describes segregation laws and the loss of the vote once troops left, prompting the Exoduster migration. Reasoning: rights without enforcement collapsed into legalized oppression.
4	Analyze Gilded Age politics and economics — the power of trusts and machines and the divide between capitalists and wage earners — using a period... Notice: There's always a group that you're not in — the one where the real decisions actually get made. In 1889 a cartoonist drew America's version of it... Debrief: In 'The Bosses of the Senate,' the trusts are drawn as giants and the senators as tiny figures, with the 'People's Entrance' bolted shut. What is the cartoonist arguing about Gilded Age government, and which groups are left powerless?	The cartoonist argues that industrial trusts, not voters, controlled the Senate — that monopoly wealth had captured the government. The bolted 'People's Entrance' shows ordinary citizens — farmers and wage earners — shut out of political power.
5	Describe how industrial leaders and innovations transformed American life, and weigh the Gospel of Wealth against the conditions of the workers... Notice: A billionaire posts about donating a hospital wing — while the people who actually built his fortune can't cover rent. Real generosity, or a... Debrief: Andrew Carnegie's 'Gospel of Wealth' and the 'Next!' cartoon describe the same industrialists very differently. Make a claim about how much the Gospel of Wealth justified Gilded Age inequality, cite both sources, and explain your reasoning.	Strong answers weigh the Gospel of Wealth's claim (the rich as public-minded stewards funding libraries and schools) against the monopoly power shown in 'Next!' (Standard Oil's grip on government and industry) and Rosa's point that the wealth came from underpaid labor. Reasoning should assess whether philanthropy offsets or merely softens the inequality the monopolies produced.
6	Analyze how industrialization and immigration drove the growth of major industrial cities and shaped urban labor and living conditions. Notice: Your town runs on people who can't afford to live in it — the drivers, the cooks, the crew cleaning the building at five in the morning. That's... Debrief: Using the Ellis Island photograph and the 1890 foreign-born map, explain the relationship between immigration and the growth of America's industrial cities.	Immigrants entering through places like Ellis Island supplied the labor that industrial cities needed, and they settled where the work was — so the foreign-born population clustered in the same industrial states and cities (per the 1890 map) where factories, ports, and rail hubs concentrated jobs. Immigration and urban-industrial growth fed each other.
7	Compare 'old' and 'new' immigrants and analyze nativist responses, using a period photograph of tenement conditions. Notice: Same person steps off the boat. One country calls them an 'expat.' Another calls them an 'immigrant.' Another calls them a 'problem.' Same human... Debrief: Return to the essential question: whose America was being built, and at whose expense? Make a claim, cite evidence from at least two different spreads (including at least one image), and explain how opportunity and loss could be two sides of the same industrial expansion.	Strong responses argue that industrial America was built as real opportunity for some (immigrant homesteaders like Anna, wage-earning newcomers like Rosa, Exodusters like Isaiah) at real expense to others (Native dispossession and assimilation for Chaska, Jim Crow for Black Southerners, exploited labor and nativism in the cities). Evidence should span spreads and cite images (e.g., the Golden Spike or Torino photos vs. the Bosses of the Senate or Riis photo). Reasoning should show the same forces — railroad, factory, open door — produced both, and that who benefited often depended on race, class, and origin.

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 1 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **Golden Spike Ceremony at Promontory Summit, Utah, May 10, 1869 — completion of the first transcontinental railroad.**

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
2. Spark's question: *Everyone in this famous photo is celebrating. Ask: who is not in the picture? Whose land and labor made this moment possible but were left out of...*
3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

Teacher note: Unit thesis: 'settlement' and 'dispossession' name the same event from two vantage points. Hold the hard line — empathy for settlers is not neutrality about the taking of Native land.

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Historians' read (one reading, not the answer)
1869	Homestead Act & transcontinental railroad	Mixed Genuinely contested against the 'more perfect union' yardstick: historians widely credit these policies with democratizing landownership and...
1877	Compromise of 1877 ends Reconstruction	Setback Broad scholarly consensus (e.g., Eric Foner) holds that withdrawing federal enforcement enabled Black disenfranchisement and racial violence - a...
1881	Tennessee's separate-car law	Setback Codifying racial segregation in law is broadly accepted by historians as a retreat from equal protection under the law.
1887	Dawes Act	Setback Widely assessed by historians as destructive: allotment contributed to the loss of roughly two-thirds of tribal lands and eroded Native...
1890	Sherman Antitrust Act	Climb Broadly regarded as a foundational check on concentrated economic power and a step toward fairer markets, though scholars note early enforcement...
1892	Ida B. Wells's anti-lynching campaign	Climb Recognized as a landmark in the struggle for equal justice and a free press - a moral and civic advance - even though the federal legislative...
1896	Tennessee ends convict leasing	Climb Ending the lease of prisoners to private companies is accepted as a labor and human-rights advance; historians note the state then shifted to its...
1901	NY Tenement House Act	Climb A landmark Progressive housing-reform law broadly credited with improving urban living conditions and public health.
1911	Standard Oil broken up	Climb Widely treated as a milestone in curbing monopoly power and enforcing antitrust law, though economists still debate its long-run market effects.

B Debrief & Closing Argument

This unit is one chapter of a project older than any of us - the one the Constitution names in its first line: forming 'a more perfect union.'...

Closing question: Look for a pattern across these seven stories: a problem gets ignored until it hurts people badly enough that someone refuses to stay silent - and their voice (a photograph, a newspaper, a strike, a vote) pushes the government to act. Sometimes the fix came fast (the Sherman Antitrust Act; Tennessee ending convict leasing). Sometimes it took generations (a federal anti-lynching law). Sometimes the government itself caused the harm (federal Indian policy). Choose two moments from this unit and argue, with evidence: in these years, did the country climb toward a 'more perfect union,' or slip back? There is no answer key - defend yours.

Facilitation: There is no single correct verdict — students must choose moments and defend a direction with evidence. Reward a claim that holds competing truths (opportunity *and* injustice in the same years) over a tidy one-sided answer.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now:

Answers vary; look for direct use of unit evidence and a defensible position, not a memorized "right" answer.

Turning the Light On

The Progressive Era • 1890–1920 | Standards US.08, US.09, US.10, US.11, US.12, US.13, US.14, US.15, US.16, US.17, US.18

- Archive (J. Troop)
- Spark
- Navigator
- Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

When a booming country leaves millions behind, who decides to fix it — and how? Progressive-era Americans fought over whether the answer was charity, protest, journalism, unions, or the government itself. Which of them actually moved the country?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories (definitions shown).

Social Darwinism	A misuse of evolution claiming the rich deserved wealth and the poor deserved poverty by 'survival of the fittest.'	muckraker	A journalist who investigated and exposed corruption and abuse to spark reform.
trust	A giant combination of companies that controlled an industry and limited competition.	collective bargaining	Workers negotiating as a group (a union) for better pay, hours, and safety.
suffrage	The right to vote.	initiative & referendum	Reforms letting citizens propose and vote directly on laws.

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Key (one defensible read)
1	Analyze Social Darwinism as a justification for inequality, and compare Washington's and Du Bois's strategies for Black advancement. Notice: Somebody tells you the rich are rich because they're simply better — stronger, smarter, more deserving — and the poor earned their poverty by... Debrief: Washington and Du Bois wanted the same goal but chose opposite strategies. Explain each strategy in one sentence, then argue which one you think fit the dangers of 1900 better — using evidence.	Washington: build economic strength and skills first, accept segregation temporarily, expect rights to follow. Du Bois: demand full civil and political rights and higher education immediately, and protest. Strong answers weigh the deadly risks of open protest in the Jim Crow South against the moral and practical cost of accepting segregation — and take a defensible position with evidence.
2	Explain how farmers (Granger/Populist) and workers (labor unions) organized to fight railroads and industry — and what it cost them. Notice: One company sets the price, and you have no choice but to pay it — sound familiar? For Anna's family, that company was the railroad, and the price... Debrief: Farmers and industrial workers used different tactics but shared one core idea. Name the shared idea, then give one tactic each group used and one risk each faced.	Shared idea: strength in numbers / collective action. Farmers used cooperatives and lobbying for Granger Laws (risk: courts and railroads overturning regulations). Workers used strikes, collective bargaining, and boycotts (risk: violent suppression and defeat, as at Homestead in 1892).
3	Analyze how trusts concentrated power, and how Roosevelt's Square Deal and Wilson's New Freedom used government to check it. Notice: Imagine one company owns the app, the phone, the store, and the road to the store — so there's nowhere else to go and no price but theirs. That... Debrief: Trace one path from problem to fix: start with the power of the trusts, and explain how journalism and government together checked it. Name at least one muckraker and one law or agency.	Trusts concentrated power and hurt competition and consumers. Ida Tarbell's exposé of Standard Oil mobilized public opinion; Roosevelt used the Sherman Act to bust trusts and passed the Pure Food and Drug Act, and Wilson added the Clayton Act, FTC, and Federal Reserve. Strong answers connect the voice (journalism/public pressure) to the specific government response.
4	Analyze industrial working conditions — child labor, sweatshops, and the Triangle fire — and the reforms they provoked. Notice: 146 people went to work one morning and never came home — most of them girls not much older than you, some younger. The factory doors were locked... Debrief: The Triangle fire is often called a turning point. Explain what conditions caused so many deaths, and how the tragedy changed what the government required of factories.	Deaths were worsened by locked doors, overcrowding, and inadequate fire escapes in an unregulated factory. The public outrage led New York's Factory Investigating Commission to enact landmark workplace-safety laws (1911–1914). Strong answers connect the specific unsafe conditions to the specific policy response.
5	Explain how muckrakers exposed abuses and mobilized public support for reform. Notice: You post a video of something wrong — a scam, a cover-up — and by morning it's everywhere and somebody powerful has to answer for it. That... Debrief: Explain how a single book led to a federal law in 1906 — and why Sinclair considered the result a partial failure.	Sinclair's 'The Jungle' exposed the filthy meatpacking industry; public disgust pressured Congress to pass the Pure Food and Drug Act and Meat Inspection Act. Sinclair saw it as partial failure because he wanted to help exploited workers, but the reforms addressed food safety, not labor conditions.
6	Analyze Progressive democratic reforms that expanded citizen control (initiative, referendum, recall, direct primaries, 16th & 17th Amendments). Notice: What if you could skip the middleman and vote directly on the rule itself — no crooked politician required? That's not a fantasy app. It's what... Debrief: Choose two Progressive democratic reforms and explain how each one shifted power away from political machines or state legislatures and toward ordinary citizens.	Examples: the initiative/referendum let citizens make laws directly (bypassing corrupt legislatures); the recall let voters remove officials; direct primaries let voters, not bosses, choose candidates; the 17th Amendment moved senator selection from state legislatures to the voters. Strong answers name two and explain the power shift for each.
7	Analyze the women's suffrage movement and the ratification of the 19th Amendment — decided in Tennessee. Notice: It comes down to one vote. One state left to make women's suffrage the law of the land, and that state is Tennessee. The count is tied. And the... Debrief: The 19th Amendment is a triumph and an unfinished one. Explain how women won the vote (including Tennessee's deciding role) AND why the victory was incomplete for many Black women.	Women won through decades of organizing — parades, lobbying, civil disobedience — culminating in Tennessee's deciding ratification on August 18, 1920 (Harry Burn's vote). It was incomplete because Jim Crow laws (poll taxes, literacy tests, intimidation) still blocked many Black women from voting for decades. Strong answers hold the triumph and the limit together.

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 2 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **dubois-souls**

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
2. Spark's question: *Both men were brilliant, brave, and right about some things. Instead of picking a 'winner,' ask: what did each strategy risk, and what did each...*
3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

Teacher note: US.08/09. Steelman both leaders; do not let students flatten Washington into a coward or Du Bois into a radical. Fisk is the Tennessee anchor.

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Historians' read (one reading, not the answer)
1892	Homestead Strike crushed	Setback Historians broadly treat the violent defeat of the Homestead strikers as a major setback for organized labor and worker power.
1895	Atlanta Compromise (Washington)	Mixed Genuinely debated: historians disagree over whether Washington's accommodation strategy protected Black lives and built strength, or postponed the...
1906	Pure Food & Drug and Meat Inspection Acts	Climb Widely regarded as landmark consumer-protection laws and a step toward a fairer, safer market.
1911	Triangle Shirtwaist fire	Setback A preventable industrial tragedy broadly marked as a low point that exposed the human cost of unregulated industry.
1913	17th Amendment (direct election of senators)	Climb Broadly seen as an expansion of direct democracy and citizen control.
1914	Clayton Act & Federal Trade Commission	Climb Widely treated as strengthening antitrust enforcement and market fairness.
1920	19th Amendment ratified in Tennessee	Climb One of the largest single expansions of the franchise in U.S. history, though Jim Crow still blocked many Black women in practice.

B Debrief & Closing Argument

If Unit 1 was the country growing fast and leaving people behind, Unit 2 is the country arguing about what it owes the people it left. Watch...

Closing question: Across this unit you saw at least five kinds of power try to fix a broken system: charity, protest, unions, journalism, and the law. Pick the two you think actually moved the country the most, cite evidence from the unit, and defend your ranking. There's no answer key — make the case.

Facilitation: There is no single correct verdict — students must choose moments and defend a direction with evidence. Reward a claim that holds competing truths (opportunity *and* injustice in the same years) over a tidy one-sided answer.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now:

Answers vary; look for direct use of unit evidence and a defensible position, not a memorized "right" answer.

On the Menu

Imperialism & World War I · 1898–1919 | Standards US.19, US.20, US.21, US.22, US.23, US.24, US.25, US.26, US.27

- Archive (J. Troop)
- Spark
- Navigator
- Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

In one generation the United States went from healing its own wounds to reaching across the whole world — buying navies, taking islands, and finally sending two million young men to a war in the mud of France. When a country grows into a world power, who pays for the growth? And when it wins, what does it owe the people it now controls?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories (definitions shown).

imperialism	A policy of extending a nation's power by taking colonies or controlling other lands and peoples.	anti-imperialist	Someone who opposed the U.S. ruling other peoples without their consent.
yellow journalism	Sensational, exaggerated news written to stir emotion and sell papers — and, in 1898, to push for war.	Big Stick diplomacy	Theodore Roosevelt's approach of negotiating while backing it with the threat of military force.
militarism	Building up huge armies and navies and glorifying military power — one of the MAIN causes of WWI.	propaganda	Information, often one-sided or misleading, spread to shape how people think — used heavily on the WWI home front.
self-determination	The idea that a people should get to choose their own government — central to Wilson's Fourteen Points.	League of Nations	The world peace organization Wilson proposed after WWI — which the U.S. Senate refused to join.

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Key (one defensible read)
1	Analyze the economic, strategic, and ideological motives behind American imperialism, and the debate between imperialists and anti-imperialists. Notice: Picture a menu — but the items aren't food. They're countries. Cuba, Puerto Rico, the Philippines, Hawaii, all laid out like dishes, and a giant... Debrief: Name the three main motives for American imperialism, then explain the core argument the Anti-Imperialist League used against it. Whose reasoning do you find stronger, and why?	Motives: economic (foreign markets and raw materials), strategic (a strong navy needing overseas bases, per Mahan), and ideological (a mission to spread American civilization). The Anti-Imperialist League argued that ruling peoples without their consent betrayed the founding principle of government by consent of the governed. Strong answers take a defensible position and use evidence, ideally weighing national benefit against the consent principle.
2	Analyze the causes, course, and consequences of the Spanish-American War, and how Roosevelt's Big Stick and Taft's Dollar Diplomacy extended U.S.... Notice: A ship blows up in a harbor. Nobody knows exactly why. But two newspapers, locked in a war for readers, splash it across their front pages... Debrief: Explain how the Spanish-American War turned the U.S. into an imperial power, then compare Big Stick and Dollar Diplomacy as two ways of using that new power. Include the war's consequences for Filipinos.	The 90-day war (1898) — driven by sympathy for Cuba, business interests, yellow journalism, and the Maine explosion — left the U.S. controlling Puerto Rico, Guam, the Philippines, and Cuba. Big Stick (Roosevelt) used the threat of force and built the Panama Canal; Dollar Diplomacy (Taft) used economic investment. For Filipinos it meant the Philippine-American War (1899–1902) and continued occupation. Strong answers connect the war's outcome to the debate over how to wield new power.
3	Analyze the long-term causes of World War I (MAIN) and the reasons the United States abandoned neutrality and entered the war. Notice: Europe in 1914 was a room full of people soaked in gasoline, and everyone was holding a match and swearing they'd only light it if someone else... Debrief: Explain the MAIN causes of World War I, then explain how the U.S. moved from neutrality to war. Identify the two events that most turned American opinion.	MAIN: Militarism (arms buildups), Alliances (Triple Alliance vs. Triple Entente), Imperialism (colonial rivalry), Nationalism (national pride/tension); spark = assassination of Franz Ferdinand (1914). The U.S. stayed neutral until German unrestricted submarine warfare (the Lusitania, 1915) and the Zimmermann Telegram (1917) turned opinion; Wilson asked for war in April 1917 to make 'the world safe for democracy.' Strong answers name the Lusitania and the Zimmermann Telegram as the key turning events.
4	Analyze the American military experience in World War I — trench warfare, deadly new technologies, and Pershing's American Expeditionary Forces —... Notice: Imagine a war where you live in a muddy ditch for months, where poison gas can roll in on the wind, where a machine gun can cut down a hundred men... Debrief: Describe what made World War I combat so deadly, and explain the role of the American Expeditionary Forces. Then explain why Alvin York's story is more complicated than 'brave soldier.'	WWI combat was deadly because of trench warfare plus new technologies — machine guns, poison gas, tanks, artillery, airplanes. The AEF under Pershing brought fresh manpower in 1918 that helped the exhausted Allies win, at heavy cost. York's story is complicated because he began as a would-be conscientious objector who did not believe in killing, wrestled with his faith, and only then became a decorated hero — his courage included moral struggle. Strong answers capture that tension.
5	Analyze the World War I home front — women's expanded roles, mobilization and war bonds, and the Committee on Public Information's propaganda. Notice: Here's something they don't always tell you about war: most of the people fighting it never see the front. They're at home, and their whole world... Debrief: Describe two major ways World War I changed the American home front, then explain what the Committee on Public Information was and one reason it is controversial.	Home-front changes included women taking on new jobs (factories, offices, nursing, farms) and civilians rationing food and buying war bonds. The CPI was the government's large-scale propaganda agency (posters, films, speakers) built to rally support for the war; it is controversial because it also demonized Germans and pressured critics into silence, blurring the line between informing and manipulating the public. Strong answers name a genuine change and a genuine concern.
6	Analyze Wilson's Fourteen Points, the Treaty of Versailles, and the debate over the League of Nations — including Tennessee's internationalist voice. Notice: The war is over. Ten million soldiers are dead. And an American president stands up and says: what if we made sure this never happens again? What... Debrief: Explain Wilson's Fourteen Points and the League of Nations, then explain why the U.S. Senate rejected the Treaty of Versailles. Was the Senate's decision wise or a mistake? Defend your answer.	The Fourteen Points (1918) proposed open diplomacy, freedom of the seas, self-determination, and a League of Nations to prevent future wars. The Treaty of Versailles (1919) created the League but harshly punished Germany. The Senate, led by Henry Cabot Lodge, rejected it, fearing the League would commit the U.S. to future wars without congressional consent. Strong answers take a defensible position, weighing the value of collective security against concerns about sovereignty and war powers.

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 3 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **This 1898 political cartoon depicts Uncle Sam as a customer eyeing a menu of Spanish colonies like Cuba and the Philippines served by President McKinley, critiquing U.S. imperial ambitions during the Spanish-American War as covered in Tennessee US.26.**

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
2. Spark's question: *This is the 'menu' cartoon itself — Uncle Sam deciding which country to 'order,' served by President McKinley. Ask: the cartoonist drew whole...*
3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

Teacher note: US.19/20. Steelman the expansionists; give the anti-imperialists and the colonized voice equal dignity. Andrés is the moral hinge of the unit. TN anchor: Southern reunion through the 1898 war.

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Historians' read (one reading, not the answer)
1898	Spanish-American War: the U.S. becomes an empire	Mixed Historians widely agree the war made the U.S. a world power, but genuinely debate whether acquiring overseas subjects was an advance for the...
1899	Philippine-American War	Setback Broadly treated as a costly war of conquest against a people seeking self-rule — a clear setback for the principle of self-determination the U.S....
1904	Panama Canal & the Roosevelt Corollary (Big Stick)	Mixed The canal was a major strategic and engineering achievement for U.S. power, but it came via a U.S.-backed revolution against Colombia and an...
1917	The United States enters World War I	Mixed Entry made the U.S. a leading world power and helped end the war, but at great human cost and with real curbs on civil liberties — historians...
1918	The Fourteen Points: a new vision of peace	Climb Widely regarded as a landmark articulation of a rules-based, cooperative international order — an advance for the ideal of peace even though it...
1919	The Senate rejects the Treaty and the League	Mixed Genuinely contested: some historians see the rejection as a tragic retreat from world leadership, others as a defensible defense of constitutional...

B Debrief & Closing Argument

Units 1 and 2 asked what the country owed the people inside it. Unit 3 asks a bigger, harder version: what does a rising world power owe the...

Closing question: This unit put a hard idea on the table: a nation can grow more powerful at the same moment it does real harm to a people. Choose one event from this unit and argue two things at once — how it strengthened the United States, AND what it cost, and to whom. Then take a stand: was the trade worth it? Cite the unit. There's no answer key — make the case honestly.

Facilitation: There is no single correct verdict — students must choose moments and defend a direction with evidence. Reward a claim that holds competing truths (opportunity *and* injustice in the same years) over a tidy one-sided answer.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now:

Answers vary; look for direct use of unit evidence and a defensible position, not a memorized "right" answer.

Who Got to Roar

The Roaring Twenties · 1920–1929 | Standards US.28, US.29, US.30, US.31, US.32, US.33, US.34, US.35, US.36, US.37, US.38

Archive (J. Troop)

Spark

Navigator

Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

The 1920s are remembered as one long party — jazz, cars, radio, and easy money. But a decade can roar for some people while it slams the door on others. Who actually got to roar in the Twenties, who got shut out, and was a country changing this fast becoming freer — or just louder?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories (definitions shown).

Great Migration	The movement of millions of African Americans out of the rural South to Northern and Western cities (roughly 1916–1970).	Harlem Renaissance	A 1920s flowering of Black literature, art, and music centered in Harlem, New York.
mass culture	Shared entertainment and information — radio, movies, records — experienced by millions of people at once.	flapper	A 1920s young woman who broke with Victorian rules through new fashion, behavior, and independence.
fundamentalism vs. modernism	The 1920s clash between literal biblical belief and modern science and culture — dramatized by the Scopes Trial.	Prohibition	The nationwide ban on making and selling alcohol (1920–1933) under the 18th Amendment.
buying on margin	Buying stocks with mostly borrowed money, betting prices will keep rising.	nativism	Favoring native-born citizens and opposing immigrants — a powerful force behind 1920s immigration limits.

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Key (one defensible read)
1	Analyze the causes and effects of the Great Migration, and how it fed the Harlem Renaissance's celebration of Black identity. Notice: Imagine leaving the only home you've ever known — not for a vacation, but because staying could get you killed. You pack one suitcase, board a... Debrief: Explain the Great Migration using push and pull factors, then explain how it connected to the Harlem Renaissance. Use one piece of evidence (a source or figure) from the spread.	Push factors: Jim Crow segregation, racial violence, disenfranchisement, and poverty in the South. Pull factors: industrial jobs, higher wages, and greater freedom in Northern/Western cities. The Migration concentrated Black Americans in cities like Harlem, fueling the Harlem Renaissance — a flowering of Black art and music (e.g., Langston Hughes's 'I, Too,' Louis Armstrong's jazz) that celebrated Black identity. Strong answers cite a specific figure or source.
2	Explain how radio spread American music nationwide, making Nashville the capital of country music and carrying the blues into the mainstream. Notice: Your favorite song right now — how did you find it? A stream, an algorithm, a phone. Now erase all of that. In 1925 a brand-new machine did... Debrief: Explain how radio changed American music in the 1920s, and give one example each of how it spread country music and the blues. Why is Tennessee central to this story?	Radio let millions hear the same music simultaneously, spreading regional styles nationwide. Country: WSM's Grand Ole Opry (1925) made Nashville the country-music capital. Blues: Bessie Smith's millions of record sales (with roots in W.C. Handy's Memphis) carried the blues mainstream. Tennessee is central because Nashville (Opry/country) and Memphis (Beale Street/blues) were both hearths of this music.
3	Analyze how radio and film, new technologies (aviation, electricity), and Ford's assembly line created a modern mass-consumer society. Notice: One man flies alone across an entire ocean, and by the time he lands, the whole planet already knows his name — because a new machine carried the... Debrief: Choose two of these — radio/film, aviation or electrification, or the automobile — and explain how each made American life more modern in the 1920s. Include one cost or trade-off.	Radio/film created mass culture (shared entertainment, celebrities like Lindbergh, national advertising). Electrification/appliances changed home life. The automobile (via Ford's assembly line) gave ordinary families mobility and created highways and suburbs. Trade-offs might include monotonous assembly-line work, unequal access to the new prosperity, or growing consumer debt. Strong answers pair a genuine change with an honest cost.
4	Analyze the changing roles and status of women in the 1920s — flappers, the birth-control movement, and the limits that remained. Notice: Cut your hair short. Wear what you want. Go out without asking permission. Get a job, spend your own money, and dance to music your grandmother... Debrief: Describe two ways women's lives changed in the 1920s and two limits that remained. Was the 'new woman' mostly real freedom or mostly hype? Defend your answer with evidence.	Changes: flapper fashion and social freedoms; more women working (about 1 in 4 by 1930); the vote (1920); the birth-control movement. Limits: about 60% of men's wages, job discrimination, expectation to quit at marriage, narrow 'women's jobs.' Strong answers take a defensible position weighing genuine new freedoms against persistent economic and social inequality.
5	Analyze the civil-liberties and civil-rights challenges of the 1920s — the Red Scare, the Klan's resurgence, the Tulsa massacre, and immigration... Notice: A country gets scared. Scared of radicals, scared of immigrants, scared of anyone who looks or prays or votes differently. And instead of talking... Debrief: Identify three examples of intolerance or civil-liberties violations in the 1920s, then explain how Americans organized to resist. Why might these events have been left out of the 'Roaring Twenties' story for so long?	Examples (any three): the Palmer Raids/Red Scare; the revived KKK; the 1921 Tulsa massacre; the 1924 National Origins Act. Resistance: the NAACP, Ida B. Wells-Barnett's anti-lynching work, and Marcus Garvey's UNIA. Strong answers note that the celebratory 'Roaring Twenties' image and the marginalization of victims' histories helped keep these events out of popular memory.
6	Analyze Prohibition — its goals, its unintended consequences (organized crime), and its ultimate failure and repeal. Notice: What happens when you make something illegal that millions of people refuse to stop wanting? You don't end it — you just hand the whole business... Debrief: Explain why many Americans supported Prohibition, then explain its main unintended consequences and why it was repealed. What general lesson does Prohibition teach about laws?	Supporters (temperance and church movements) believed banning alcohol would reduce poverty, family harm, and crime. Unintended consequences: a massive illegal industry — bootlegging, speakeasies, and organized crime (e.g., Al Capone). It was nearly unenforceable and was repealed by the 21st Amendment (1933). Lesson: passing a law does not automatically change behavior, especially when it conflicts with what large numbers of people want to do.
7	Analyze the Scopes Trial as a dramatization of the clash between fundamentalism and modernism — staged in Dayton, Tennessee. Notice: A small Tennessee town. A young teacher. A law that makes it a crime to teach where humans came from. In the summer of 1925, the whole country —... Debrief: Explain what the Scopes Trial was about and why it mattered beyond one teacher. Represent both Bryan's and Darrow's positions fairly, then explain why historians say 'no one really won.'	Scopes was tried under Tennessee's Butler Act for teaching evolution. It mattered because it dramatized the national clash between fundamentalism (Bryan: literal Bible, protecting tradition) and modernism (Darrow: modern science and academic freedom). 'No one really won' because Scopes was convicted (a legal win for fundamentalists) while national press coverage made fundamentalism look outdated (a cultural win for modernists) — the underlying divide remained. Strong answers steelman both sides.
8	Analyze the economic weaknesses of the 1920s — easy credit, stock speculation, and inequality — that set up the Great Depression. Notice: Buy it now, pay later. Put ten percent down and borrow the rest. Everyone's getting rich in the stock market, so throw your money in — prices only...	Credit: installment 'buy now, pay later' buying left consumers and businesses deep in debt. Speculation: buying stocks on margin (mostly borrowed money) meant falling prices would trigger cascading debt. Inequality: wealth concentrated at the top while farmers/workers were left out, weakening overall demand. Together

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Key (one defensible read)
	Debrief: Explain three economic weaknesses of the 1920s (credit, speculation, inequality) and how each helped set up the Great Depression. Which do you think was most dangerous, and why?	they made the economy fragile, and it collapsed in 1929. Strong answers defend a choice of the 'most dangerous' with reasoning.

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 4 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **An African American family of nine, dressed in coats and hats with their suitcases at their feet, photographed shortly after arriving in Chicago during the Great Migration, when hundreds of thousands of Black Americans moved from the rural South to northern cities.**²⁸ on the Great Migration.

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
2. Spark's question: *This is a real family, photographed just after arriving in Chicago from the South around 1920 — coats on, suitcases at their feet. Ask: what can...*
3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

Teacher note: US.28/33. Keep the Migration honest about Northern hardship; keep the Renaissance joyful and central. Real people (Hughes, Hurston, Armstrong) appear via cited photos/texts only. TN anchor: Memphis/Beale/Handy.

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Historians' read (one reading, not the answer)
1920	Prohibition begins (18th Amendment)	Mixed Historians read Prohibition as a genuinely mixed experiment — sincere reform goals and some reduced consumption against enormous unintended costs...
1921	Tulsa Race Massacre	Setback Broadly recognized as one of the worst incidents of racial violence in U.S. history — an unambiguous setback for justice.
1924	National Origins Act restricts immigration	Setback Widely treated as a nativist, racially motivated narrowing of the nation's openness to newcomers — a setback for the country's founding openness.
1925	The Great Migration and Harlem Renaissance	Climb Broadly celebrated as a landmark flowering of Black identity and a step toward fuller participation in national life — a clear advance on the...
1925	The Grand Ole Opry puts Nashville on the map	Climb Regarded as a founding moment of country music and 1920s mass culture — a genuine cultural advance, if a modest one on the union's yardstick.
1925	The Scopes Trial	Mixed Genuinely contested — fundamentalists won the verdict while modernists won much of public opinion — so historians read it as a cultural draw and...
1929	The credit boom crests	Mixed The decade's growth was real but unevenly shared and financed by unsustainable credit and speculation, so its health is debated and it is marked...

B Debrief & Closing Argument

The Twenties are the trickiest decade yet for the 'more perfect union' question, because progress and backlash happen at the exact same time. The...

Closing question: The 1920s advanced some Americans and set others back — often in the very same year. Pick two events from this unit that pulled the country in opposite directions, and use them to argue whether the decade, on balance, moved the United States closer to its founding promise or further from it. Cite the unit. There's no answer key — make the case.

Facilitation: There is no single correct verdict — students must choose moments and defend a direction with evidence. Reward a claim that holds competing truths (opportunity *and* injustice in the same years) over a tidy one-sided answer.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now:

Answers vary; look for direct use of unit evidence and a defensible position, not a memorized "right" answer.

When the Bottom Fell Out

The Great Depression & the New Deal • 1929–1941 | Standards US.39, US.40, US.41, US.42, US.43, US.44

Archive (J. Troop) Spark Navigator
Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

In 1929 the richest country on earth fell into its worst economic disaster, and one in four workers lost their jobs through no fault of their own. When the bottom falls out for millions of people, whose job is it to catch them — themselves, their neighbors, or their government? The answer America argued out in the 1930s still shapes your life today.

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories (definitions shown).

buying on margin	Buying stocks with mostly borrowed money — a major cause of the 1929 crash.	Dust Bowl	The 1930s ecological disaster when plowed-up Plains soil blew away in huge dust storms.
Hooverville	A shantytown of homeless Depression families, named mockingly for President Hoover.	rugged individualism	Hoover's belief that people should rely on themselves and private charity, not federal relief.
the New Deal	FDR's 1933–1939 programs to fight the Depression through Relief, Recovery, and Reform.	Relief, Recovery, Reform	The 'Three Rs' of the New Deal: help now, restart the economy, and fix the system long-term.
TVA	The Tennessee Valley Authority — a government agency that built dams and brought electricity to the rural South.	court-packing	FDR's failed 1937 plan to add Supreme Court justices who would uphold the New Deal.

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Key (one defensible read)
1	Analyze the interlocking causes of the Great Depression — margin buying, bank failures, overproduction, and the Smoot-Hawley Tariff. Notice: You buy something with money you don't have, betting you'll pay it back when your investment goes up. Everybody's doing it, so it feels safe.... Debrief: Explain how a stock market crash turned into a decade-long Depression. Identify at least three causes and show how one caused or worsened another.	Causes include margin buying (amplified the crash and left unpayable debts), bank failures (wiped out savings, no FDIC), overproduction (layoffs → less spending), agricultural weakness, and the Smoot-Hawley Tariff (collapsed world trade). Strong answers show a chain — e.g., crash → bank failures → business closings → unemployment → less spending → more failures — the vicious cycle that pushed unemployment to ~25%.
2	Analyze the human-caused ecological disaster of the Dust Bowl and the forced migration and discrimination it produced. Notice: Imagine the sky itself turning against you. A wall of black dust two thousand feet high, rolling across the horizon at sixty miles an hour... Debrief: Explain why the Dust Bowl is called a 'human-caused' disaster, not just a natural one. Then describe what happened to families like Opal's, and how <i>The Grapes of Wrath</i> changed public understanding.	Human-caused: farmers plowed up deep-rooted prairie grass that had held the soil, so when drought hit, the exposed topsoil blew away. Families lost farms and over 400,000 migrated west ('Okies'), facing discrimination and crashing wages in California. Steinbeck's <i>The Grapes of Wrath</i> (1939) portrayed the Joad family sympathetically, making Americans see migrants as dignified human beings. Strong answers connect the farming practices + drought and the human/social results.
3	Analyze the human toll of the Great Depression — mass unemployment, Hoovervilles, hunger, and the unequal way it fell. Notice: One in four. Picture your class, and cross out every fourth person's job — gone. Now imagine there's no unemployment check, no food stamps, no... Debrief: Describe three ways the Depression harmed ordinary Americans, and explain why it fell harder on some groups than others. Why might a photograph like 'Migrant Mother' change minds when statistics don't?	Harms (any three): ~25% unemployment; Hoovervilles/homelessness; breadlines and hunger; foreclosures; teenagers riding the rails; psychological trauma. It fell harder on groups already at the bottom — e.g., Black Americans were 'last hired, first fired' with much higher unemployment. A photograph like 'Migrant Mother' puts a human face on abstract numbers, creating empathy that statistics alone often don't. Strong answers address inequality explicitly.
4	Analyze Hoover's response to the Depression — 'rugged individualism,' the RFC, and the Bonus Army — and why it failed politically. Notice: You're the president. A quarter of the country is out of work, people are starving, and everyone is looking at you. You genuinely believe that if... Debrief: Explain Hoover's philosophy of 'rugged individualism' and how it shaped his response to the Depression. Then explain how the Bonus Army episode helped end his presidency. Was his philosophy wrong, or just wrong for this crisis? Defend your view.	Rugged individualism held that self-reliance and private charity, not federal relief, preserved American character; Hoover therefore avoided direct relief and used indirect tools like the RFC (trickle-down). The Bonus Army's violent dispersal (tear gas/tanks against veterans) horrified the public and helped cause his 1932 landslide loss. Strong answers take a defensible position on whether the philosophy itself or its fit to this crisis was the core problem.
5	Analyze FDR's New Deal through the 'Three Rs' — Relief, Recovery, and Reform — and the lasting institutions it created. Notice: A minimum wage. A limit on your work week. Insurance so your grandparents don't starve when they're old. Insurance so your family's bank savings... Debrief: Explain the 'Three Rs' of the New Deal with one program for each. Then explain one way the New Deal fell short of helping all Americans equally. Which New Deal program do you think mattered most, and why?	Relief (immediate help: CCC, WPA), Recovery (restart economy: AAA, NRA), Reform (long-term fixes: FDIC, SEC, Wagner Act, FLSA, Social Security). Shortfall: early Social Security excluded farm and domestic workers (many of them Black), and local administration could discriminate. Strong answers defend a 'most important' choice (e.g., Social Security or FDIC) with reasoning.
6	Analyze the Tennessee Valley Authority as the New Deal's most dramatic regional transformation — flood control, electrification, and its impact on... Notice: Flip a switch. Light. You've done it ten thousand times without a thought. Now imagine you're seventeen and you have never once done it — every... Debrief: Explain what the TVA did and why it mattered so much to the rural South. Then explain one benefit and one cost or controversy of a government building and owning something like the TVA.	The TVA (1933) built dams across the Tennessee Valley to control floods, improve navigation, and generate cheap electricity, bringing power to rural households where only ~10% had it. Benefit: it did what private companies wouldn't (wiring poor rural areas), transforming daily life and the regional economy. Cost/controversy: government-owned power competed with private companies (raising 'socialism' fears), and building dams flooded land and displaced some families. Strong answers give a real benefit and a real cost.
7	Analyze the opposition to the New Deal, the Supreme Court's rejection of key programs, and FDR's failed court-packing plan. Notice: What happens when a president does so much, so fast, that people start asking whether he's rescuing democracy or endangering it? The New Deal... Debrief: Explain why the New Deal faced opposition, how the Supreme Court responded, and why FDR's court-packing plan failed. What does this fight show about the balance of power in American government?	Opposition: critics (American Liberty League) called it socialism and government overreach. The Court struck down the NRA (1935) and AAA (1936) as unconstitutional. FDR's 1937 court-packing plan to add justices failed because even allies saw it as a dangerous power grab; the Court then began upholding New Deal laws anyway. The fight shows the checks and balances at work: the New Deal expanded federal power, but the Constitution constrained the president. Strong answers address that balance.

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 5 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **hoover-business-sound-1929**

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
2. Spark's question: *Four days later the market suffered the worst crash in its history, and within four years more than 9,000 banks had failed. Ask: why would the...*
3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

Teacher note: US.39 and the bridge from Unit 4. Dot's continuity pays off the credit-boom cliffhanger. Keep causes interlocking, not a list. TN anchor: Caldwell and Company, Nashville.

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Historians' read (one reading, not the answer)
1929	The stock market crash	Setback Universally treated as the onset of the worst economic disaster in U.S. history — an unambiguous setback.
1932	The Bonus Army is driven from Washington	Setback Broadly seen as a low point of the Hoover years — the federal government using force against veterans seeking help.
1933	The New Deal begins	Climb Widely regarded as a landmark expansion of government's responsibility for economic security, though its size is genuinely debated — so consensus...
1933	The TVA lights up the Tennessee Valley	Climb Broadly celebrated as a transformative public-works success that modernized a whole region — with the acknowledged cost that some families were...
1935	Social Security is enacted	Climb Regarded as one of the most important laws in U.S. history and a major advance in economic security, though its initial exclusions (farm and...
1937	The court-packing plan fails	Mixed Genuinely contested: some see the plan's failure as democracy protecting itself from overreach, others as an obstacle to needed reform — so it is...

B Debrief & Closing Argument

This unit is where America rewrites the deal between a person and their government. For 150 years the answer to 'who catches you when you fall'...

Closing question: The New Deal permanently expanded what the federal government does for ordinary people — and Americans have argued about whether that was rescue or overreach ever since. Using at least two programs from this unit, argue whether the New Deal moved the country closer to its founding promise or further from it. Then name one thing it left unfinished. Cite the unit — there's no answer key.

Facilitation: There is no single correct verdict — students must choose moments and defend a direction with evidence. Reward a claim that holds competing truths (opportunity *and* injustice in the same years) over a tidy one-sided answer.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now:

Answers vary; look for direct use of unit evidence and a defensible position, not a memorized "right" answer.

The Whole World at War

World War II • 1939–1945 | Standards US.45, US.46, US.47, US.48, US.49, US.50, US.51, US.52, US.53, US.54, US.55, US.56, US.57, US.58

[Archive \(J. Troop\)](#) [Spark](#) [Navigator](#)
[Notetaker](#)

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

World War II asked the United States to save democracy abroad — while it was still denying democracy to millions of its own people at home. Can a country fight for freedom in the world and against it at home, at the same time? And when winning the war meant building the most terrible weapon ever made — in Tennessee — what did victory finally cost?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories (definitions shown).

fascism	A dictatorship built on extreme nationalism, militarism, and the crushing of dissent and minorities.	isolationism	The belief that the U.S. should stay out of foreign conflicts.
the Holocaust	Nazi Germany's systematic murder of six million Jews and millions of others.	Double V	Black Americans' World War II campaign for victory over fascism abroad and racism at home.
internment	The forced imprisonment of about 120,000 Japanese Americans, most of them citizens, under Executive Order 9066.	Rosie the Riveter	The symbol of the millions of women who took defense-industry jobs during the war.
Manhattan Project	The secret U.S. program — including Oak Ridge, Tennessee — that built the atomic bomb.	United Nations	The international organization founded in 1945 to help prevent future world wars.

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Key (one defensible read)
1	Analyze the rise of fascism and totalitarianism in Europe, and how FDR moved a reluctant America from isolationism toward supporting the democracies. Notice: Picture a hundred thousand people packed into a stadium at night, torches blazing, every arm raised in perfect unison to one man on a distant... Debrief: Define fascism and give two examples of fascist or totalitarian regimes. Then explain why most Americans were isolationist, and how FDR moved the country toward helping the Allies before Pearl Harbor.	Fascism: extreme nationalism, militarism, one-party dictatorship, and scapegoating of minorities (Mussolini's Italy, Hitler's Germany; Stalin ran a totalitarian communist USSR). Americans were isolationist due to WWI trauma and the Depression. FDR moved toward engagement via the Four Freedoms, the Atlantic Charter, and Lend-Lease (supplying Allies before U.S. entry). Strong answers connect the isolationist mood to FDR's gradual, careful shift.
2	Analyze the attack on Pearl Harbor and U.S. entry into the war, and identify the key Allied leaders and their roles. Notice: It's a sleepy Sunday morning. Sailors are still in their bunks, some at breakfast, the band tuning up for the flag-raising. And then the sky fills... Debrief: Explain what happened at Pearl Harbor and why it ended American isolationism. Then identify two Allied leaders and each one's role in the war.	Japan's surprise attack on Pearl Harbor (Dec. 7, 1941) killed ~2,400 Americans and devastated the Pacific Fleet; FDR's 'infamy' speech and the declaration of war ended isolationism (Germany/Italy then declared war on the U.S.). Leaders (any two): Churchill (Britain's PM), FDR (U.S. until 1945), Eisenhower (Europe/D-Day), MacArthur (Pacific), Truman (atomic-bomb decision). Strong answers link the attack to the sudden national unity.
3	Analyze the major American military campaigns in the European and Pacific theaters — D-Day, Midway, and the island-hopping fight to Iwo Jima. Notice: You're nineteen, in a flat-bottomed boat crossing a freezing sea toward a beach you've never seen. The ramp drops. Ahead is open sand, then... Debrief: Describe the significance of D-Day and one Pacific campaign. Explain how the two-theater war led toward Allied victory, and give one detail that conveys its human cost.	D-Day (June 6, 1944) was the largest amphibious invasion in history, opening the western front that (with the Soviet advance) defeated Germany. In the Pacific, Midway (1942) turned the tide and island-hopping (Iwo Jima/Okinawa) advanced toward Japan. Human cost: over 400,000 Americans died; beaches like Omaha were killing grounds. Strong answers connect the campaigns to eventual victory and convey the cost honestly.
4	Analyze the Holocaust and the evolving U.S. response — from refusing Jewish refugees before the war to liberating the camps at its end. Notice: Before the shooting ever reached America, a ship full of desperate people sailed to within sight of the Florida coast — and was turned away. Nine... Debrief: Explain what the Holocaust was, and describe how the U.S. response evolved from before the war to its end. Why did Eisenhower order the camps documented?	The Holocaust was the Nazis' systematic genocide of six million Jews and millions of others. The U.S. response evolved: before the war, immigration limits and prejudice turned away refugees (e.g., the SS St. Louis, 1939); at the end, American troops liberated the camps. Eisenhower ordered documentation so the atrocities could never be denied. Strong answers hold both the liberation and the earlier failure to admit refugees.
5	Analyze how Americans who faced discrimination at home — the Tuskegee Airmen and Black defense workers — fought for a 'Double V': victory abroad... Notice: Imagine risking your life for a country that makes you use a separate water fountain. You put on the uniform, you fly the missions, you bleed for... Debrief: Explain the 'Double V' campaign. Use the Tuskegee Airmen and Executive Order 8802 as examples of Black Americans fighting on two fronts. How did this experience connect to the later civil-rights movement?	Double V = victory over fascism abroad AND victory over racism at home. Tuskegee Airmen: first Black military pilots, excellent record, in a segregated military. EO 8802 (1941): banned discrimination in defense jobs (won via threatened march on Washington). The contradiction of fighting for freedom while denied it energized and organized Black Americans, fueling the postwar civil-rights movement. Strong answers make that connection explicit.
6	Analyze how the war transformed women's roles (Rosie the Riveter) and required total civilian mobilization (rationing, bonds, POW camps) on the... Notice: They told women their place was the kitchen — right up until the country needed them to build the bombers. Almost overnight, millions of women... Debrief: Explain two major ways the war changed the American home front, including women's roles. Why might the government have promoted images like 'Rosie the Riveter,' and what happened to many women workers after the war?	Changes: over six million women entered defense work ('Rosie the Riveter') and 350,000+ served in the military; civilians rationed goods, bought war bonds, and joined scrap drives; the Bracero Program filled farm labor. The government promoted 'Rosie' to recruit women into essential war work. After the war, many women were pushed out of industrial jobs when men returned, though the experience permanently changed ideas about women's capabilities. Strong answers pair a change with the postwar retreat.
7	Analyze the internment of Japanese Americans under Executive Order 9066 as a grave civil-liberties violation driven by prejudice, not security. Notice: You are an American citizen. You were born here, you pledge allegiance here, this is the only country you've ever known. Then one day the... Debrief: Explain what Executive Order 9066 did and why historians say it was based on prejudice, not security. Then explain how the story of the 442nd Regiment makes the injustice even clearer. Why does the government's later apology matter?	EO 9066 (1942) led to the internment of ~120,000 people of Japanese ancestry (two-thirds U.S. citizens) with no charges or evidence of disloyalty — prejudice and hysteria, not security. The 442nd (Japanese American soldiers, some with interned families) became the most decorated unit of its size, showing the loyalty the policy wrongly doubted. The 1988 apology and reparations matter as the nation formally admitting the injustice. Strong answers hold injustice and heroism together.
8	Analyze the Manhattan Project — including Oak Ridge, Tennessee — and the decision to drop the atomic bombs, weighing its justifications and its... Notice: A secret city rises in the Tennessee hills, so hidden it isn't on any map. Tens of thousands of people work there around the clock, most with no...	The Manhattan Project was the secret U.S. program that built the atomic bomb at sites including Oak Ridge, Tennessee (uranium enrichment). For: the bombs forced Japan's quick surrender and may have prevented an invasion that could have killed hundreds of thousands or millions. Against: they killed 200,000+ mostly civilians, and Japan may have been near surrender — destroying

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Key (one defensible read)
	Debrief: Explain what the Manhattan Project was and Tennessee's role in it. Then lay out the strongest argument FOR and AGAINST dropping the atomic bombs, and take your own position with evidence.	civilian cities is a moral catastrophe. Strong answers state both cases fairly and defend a position with evidence.
9	Analyze the Yalta Conference and the tensions leading to the Cold War, and the founding of the United Nations as America's renewed commitment to... Notice: The war is finally ending, and three men sit for a photograph that will shape the next fifty years. They're supposed to be allies, planning the... Debrief: Explain what was decided at Yalta and how it helped lead to the Cold War. Then explain why the United Nations was founded and how it differed from the U.S. response after World War I. What is Tennessee's connection?	At Yalta (Feb. 1945) the Big Three agreed to divide Germany, hold free elections in liberated Europe, and create the UN; Stalin's violation of the free-election promise and East-West distrust led to the Cold War. The UN (1945) was founded to prevent future wars, learning from the failed League of Nations — and unlike 1919, the U.S. joined and committed to engagement. Tennessee's Cordell Hull was the 'Father of the United Nations' (1945 Nobel Peace Prize). Strong answers connect back to Unit 3's League rejection.

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 6 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **SA troops march past Adolf Hitler at the 1935 Nazi Party rally in Nuremberg — mass spectacle designed to display totalitarian power.**

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
2. Spark's question: *This is a 1935 Nazi rally at Nuremberg — tens of thousands marching in perfect formation past Hitler. Ask: the Nazis staged these events on...*
3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

Teacher note: US.45/46. Treat isolationism fairly. Define fascism precisely. TN anchor: Cordell Hull as Secretary of State (ties back to Unit 3's League thread).

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Historians' read (one reading, not the answer)
1933	Fascism seizes power in Germany	Setback Universally regarded as a catastrophic rise of tyranny that led to war and genocide — an unambiguous setback for human freedom.
1941	Pearl Harbor brings the U.S. into the war	Mixed The attack pulled the U.S. into the war that made it a superpower, but at enormous human cost and against its will — so it is marked mixed and...
1942	Executive Order 9066 interns Japanese Americans	Setback Broadly recognized today as a grave civil-liberties violation driven by racism, later formally apologized for — an unambiguous setback for the...
1944	D-Day opens the road to victory in Europe	Climb Broadly celebrated as a decisive step toward defeating fascism and liberating occupied Europe — a climb, at heavy but purposeful cost.
1945	The Double V and the seeds of civil rights	Climb Widely seen as an important step that opened opportunity and fueled the postwar civil-rights movement, though it left segregation intact — its...
1945	The atomic bomb ends the war	Mixed Among the most genuinely debated decisions in history — victory and the avoidance of a bloody invasion against the mass killing of civilians and...
1945	The United Nations is founded	Climb Broadly regarded as a landmark step toward collective security and a correction of the U.S. retreat after World War I — a climb.

B Debrief & Closing Argument

World War II is the sharpest test yet of the 'more perfect union' question, because the contradiction is right on the surface: the United States...

Closing question: World War II showed the United States at its best and its worst at the very same time. Choose one example of the country fighting for freedom and one of it denying freedom, and argue what the war, on balance, did to the nation's founding promise. Then take a position on the hardest question in the unit: was the United States right to drop the atomic bombs? Cite the unit — there's no answer key.

Facilitation: There is no single correct verdict — students must choose moments and defend a direction with evidence. Reward a claim that holds competing truths (opportunity *and* injustice in the same years) over a tidy one-sided answer.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now:

Answers vary; look for direct use of unit evidence and a defensible position, not a memorized "right" answer.

A War of Nerves

The Cold War · 1945–1991 | Standards US.59, US.60, US.61, US.62, US.63, US.64, US.65, US.66, US.67, US.68, US.69, US.70

Archive (J. Troop)

Spark

Navigator

Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

For nearly half a century, the two most powerful nations on earth pointed enough weapons at each other to end the world — and never quite fired. The Cold War was fought with spies, propaganda, proxy wars, and fear instead of direct battle. How do you 'win' a war nobody dares to fight? And what does a democracy risk losing — at home — when it spends fifty years afraid?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories (definitions shown).

Cold War	The 45-year rivalry between the U.S. and USSR — fought with threats, spies, and proxy wars, not direct battle.	containment	The U.S. strategy of stopping the spread of communism.
McCarthyism	Making reckless accusations of disloyalty without evidence, named for Senator Joseph McCarthy.	brinkmanship	Threatening massive (nuclear) retaliation to force an enemy to back down.
MAD (Mutually Assured Destruction)	The idea that neither side would start a nuclear war because both would be destroyed.	proxy war	A conflict (like Korea or Vietnam) where the superpowers fight through other countries rather than each other.
détente	The 1970s easing of Cold War tensions through diplomacy and arms-control treaties.	Iron Curtain	Churchill's name for the divide between the communist East and the democratic West.

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Key (one defensible read)
1	Analyze the origins of the Cold War and the U.S. strategy of containment (Truman Doctrine, Marshall Plan, Berlin Airlift, NATO). Notice: Yesterday's ally is today's enemy. The moment the shooting stopped in 1945, the two nations that had just beaten Hitler together turned to face... Debrief: Explain how the Cold War began and what 'containment' meant. Give two examples of early containment policies and how each worked.	The Cold War began as the U.S. (democracy/capitalism) and USSR (communism) became rival superpowers after WWII, divided by an 'iron curtain,' avoiding direct war due to nuclear weapons. Containment = stopping communism's spread. Examples (any two): Truman Doctrine (aid to nations resisting communism), Marshall Plan (rebuilt Western Europe), Berlin Airlift (supplied West Berlin by air), NATO (permanent alliance). Strong answers explain how each policy served containment.
2	Analyze the Second Red Scare and McCarthyism — HUAC, the blacklist, and the Rosenberg case — as a civil-liberties crisis born of Cold War fear. Notice: Someone points at you and says you're the enemy. They have no proof — just a claim — but the claim alone is enough to get you fired, blacklisted... Debrief: Explain what McCarthyism was and how it harmed Americans, using HUAC and the blacklist. Then explain the tension the Rosenberg case reveals: how can it be true both that Soviet spies existed AND that the Red Scare went too far?	McCarthyism = reckless accusations of communism without evidence; HUAC investigated beliefs and blacklisted 300+ Hollywood artists; thousands lost jobs on suspicion. The Rosenberg case shows the tension: real Soviet espionage existed (Julius spied), yet the climate of fear produced unfair trials and punished many innocent people. Strong answers hold both truths together without dismissing either.
3	Analyze the causes, course, and outcome of the Korean War — containment's first shooting test. Notice: A line on a map, drawn in a hurry, splits a country in two — communist on one side, not on the other. Then one morning the tanks roll across it... Debrief: Explain how the Korean War tested the U.S. strategy of containment, and describe its outcome. Why was Truman's decision to fire MacArthur significant?	North Korea's 1950 invasion tested containment; the U.S. led UN forces to defend the South. Inchon reversed the war, but China's entry created a stalemate, and the 1953 armistice left Korea divided at the 38th parallel. Firing MacArthur (for publicly pushing to widen the war toward China) affirmed civilian control of the military — a core democratic principle. Strong answers connect Korea to containment and note the war's inconclusive result.
4	Analyze Eisenhower's strategy of brinkmanship and the nuclear arms race that filled American life with the fear of sudden annihilation. Notice: Your teacher stops class, and everyone crawls under their desks and covers their heads — practicing for the end of the world. That was a normal... Debrief: Explain Eisenhower's strategy of brinkmanship and the idea of Mutually Assured Destruction (MAD). Then describe two ways nuclear fear shaped everyday American life. What was Eisenhower warning about with the 'military-industrial complex'?	Brinkmanship/massive retaliation used the threat of nuclear response to deter the USSR cheaply; MAD meant neither side would start a nuclear war because both would be destroyed. Everyday effects: duck-and-cover drills, fallout shelters, pervasive nuclear anxiety in culture. Eisenhower warned that the permanent alliance of arms-makers and the military (the 'military-industrial complex') could gain dangerous influence over democracy. Strong answers connect strategy, daily fear, and the warning.
5	Analyze the Space Race as an arena of Cold War competition, from the shock of Sputnik to the Moon landing. Notice: One night in 1957, Americans went outside and looked up — and saw a Soviet machine crossing the sky. A little metal ball called Sputnik, beeping... Debrief: Explain why the launch of Sputnik alarmed Americans and how the U.S. responded. Then explain how the Space Race was really part of the Cold War, using the Moon landing as evidence.	Sputnik (1957) alarmed Americans because rockets that could orbit a satellite could also deliver nuclear weapons, and it suggested Soviet technological superiority. The U.S. responded by creating NASA (1958) and boosting science/math education. It was Cold War competition because winning space (culminating in the 1969 Apollo 11 Moon landing) was meant to prove the superiority of the American system over the Soviet one. Strong answers connect technology, fear, and ideological competition.
6	Analyze the Cuban Revolution, the Bay of Pigs, and the Cuban Missile Crisis — the closest the world came to nuclear war. Notice: Thirteen days. For thirteen days in October 1962, the entire human race was closer to nuclear annihilation than it has ever been before or since —... Debrief: Explain how the Cuban Missile Crisis began and how it was resolved. Why is it considered the most dangerous moment of the Cold War, and what did the two sides do afterward to reduce the risk of nuclear war?	It began when the U.S. discovered Soviet nuclear missiles under construction in Cuba (Oct. 1962), following Castro's communist takeover (1959) and the failed Bay of Pigs (1961). Kennedy imposed a naval blockade; after 13 tense days, Khrushchev removed the missiles in exchange for a U.S. no-invasion pledge and a secret removal of U.S. missiles from Turkey. It was the closest the world came to nuclear war; afterward both sides created the hotline and pursued arms control. Strong answers explain both the danger and the de-escalation.
7	Analyze the causes and course of the Vietnam War and the roles of Kennedy, Johnson, and Nixon in escalating and ending it. Notice: You're nineteen, drafted, and dropped into a jungle on the other side of the planet to fight an enemy you can't see, for a village that isn't sure... Debrief: Explain why the U.S. could not win in Vietnam despite its military superiority. Then summarize how Kennedy, Johnson, and Nixon each handled the war. Why is Linh's perspective important to understanding it?	The U.S. faced a guerrilla war (tunnels, ambushes, jungle, village loyalty) that neutralized its firepower and helicopters, and it couldn't translate battles into lasting political control. Kennedy raised advisers to 16,000; Johnson escalated to 500,000+ (until Tet 1968 turned opinion); Nixon pursued Vietnamization and withdrawal. Linh's (Vietnamese) perspective matters because the war was fought in Vietnamese homes, and the Vietnamese people paid the highest price with the least say. Strong answers include the Vietnamese perspective.
8	Analyze the antiwar movement and the deep divisions the Vietnam War created on the American home front. Notice: For the first time in history, Americans could watch a war on television during dinner — the real thing, blood and all, every single night. And...	Causes of division/antiwar movement: the draft (1969 lottery), nightly televised combat, the 1968 Tet Offensive contradicting government claims, and mounting casualties (plus Kent State, 1970). Some saw protest as betraying soldiers risking their lives;

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Key (one defensible read)
	Debrief: Explain why the Vietnam War so deeply divided the American home front. Give two causes of the antiwar movement, and then explain — fairly — why some Americans saw the protests as betrayal. Can you honor both the soldier and the protester?	others saw the war as morally wrong. A strong answer steelmans both, recognizing that respecting the troops and opposing the war are not necessarily contradictory — the soldier and protester were both caught in the same failed war.
9	Analyze détente and the eventual peaceful end of the Cold War, from Nixon's diplomacy to the fall of the Berlin Wall. Notice: After decades of pointing weapons at each other, the two superpowers did something almost stranger than war: they started talking. And then, one... Debrief: Explain what détente was and give two examples. Then explain how the Cold War finally ended. Why is it significant that it ended largely without direct war between the superpowers?	Détente = easing Cold War tensions through diplomacy; examples: Nixon opening relations with China and signing SALT I (1972); the Reagan-Gorbachev INF Treaty (1987). The Cold War ended as the Soviet economy failed and Gorbachev let Eastern Europe go: the Berlin Wall fell (1989), communist governments collapsed, and the USSR dissolved (1991). Its peaceful end is significant because, despite thousands of nuclear weapons, the feared direct/nuclear war never happened — it ended through diplomacy and internal collapse. Strong answers explain the peaceful resolution.

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 7 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **American transport planes at Berlin's Tempelhof Airport during the 1948–49 Berlin Airlift, which supplied 2.5 million blockaded West Berliners entirely by air.**

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
2. Spark's question: *These are American planes at Berlin during the 1948–49 airlift, feeding a blockaded city entirely from the air. Ask: the U.S. beat the Berlin...*
3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

Teacher note: US.59/60. Treat both superpowers' fears as real. Establish 'cold' war vs. shooting war. TN anchor: Oak Ridge as the Cold War nuclear engine.

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Historians' read (one reading, not the answer)
1948	The Berlin Airlift	Climb Broadly regarded as an early Cold War success — resisting Soviet pressure and saving a free city without firing a shot.
1950	The Korean War	Mixed Genuinely debated — containment held and South Korea survived, but at heavy cost and with no clear victory — so it is marked mixed and contested.
1954	The peak of McCarthyism	Setback Broadly recognized as a civil-liberties disgrace in which fear overrode due process — an unambiguous setback for the founding promise.
1962	The Cuban Missile Crisis	Mixed Both an escape from catastrophe and proof of how close the arms race brought the world to disaster — genuinely debated, so marked mixed and contested.
1969	Apollo 11 lands on the Moon	Climb Broadly celebrated as one of humanity's greatest achievements and a Cold War triumph for the United States.
1975	The fall of Saigon ends the Vietnam War	Setback Widely seen as a costly American defeat and national trauma, though its lessons remain debated — so consensus is marked contested.
1989	The Berlin Wall falls	Climb Broadly celebrated as a triumph of freedom and a peaceful end to a 45-year standoff.

B Debrief & Closing Argument

The Cold War is the 'more perfect union' question turned inward. For nearly fifty years, the United States told the world it stood for freedom...

Closing question: The Cold War asked Americans to defend freedom abroad while fear tempted them to shrink it at home. Choose one example where the U.S. lived up to its ideals in the Cold War and one where fear led it to betray them, and argue what the whole era did to the nation's founding promise. Then take a position: did the U.S. 'win' the Cold War, and at what cost? Cite the unit — there's no answer key.

Facilitation: There is no single correct verdict — students must choose moments and defend a direction with evidence. Reward a claim that holds competing truths (opportunity *and* injustice in the same years) over a tidy one-sided answer.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now:

Answers vary; look for direct use of unit evidence and a defensible position, not a memorized "right" answer.

The Good Life — and Its Fine Print

Postwar America · 1945–1963 | Standards US.71, US.72, US.73, US.74, US.75, US.76, US.77

Archive (J. Troop) Spark Navigator Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

After World War II, America built something new: a booming, comfortable, television-and-automobile good life that made it the envy of the world. But whose good life was it? Behind the shiny suburbs and the family sitcoms lay a country that offered the dream to some and quietly locked others out — and a generation of teenagers who would soon ask why. Was the 1950s a golden age, or a golden cage?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories (definitions shown).

consumer culture	A society organized around buying goods — encouraged by advertising, credit, and rising prosperity.	G.I. Bill	A 1944 law giving veterans college tuition, job training, and low-cost home loans.
suburb	A residential community outside a city, like Levittown, that boomed after the war.	baby boom	The surge of about 76 million births between 1946 and 1964.
Interstate Highway System	The 41,000-mile national highway network created in 1956 under Eisenhower.	redlining	The discriminatory practice of denying loans and housing to Black families, locking them out of the suburbs.
rock 'n' roll	1950s music born from Black rhythm and blues, centered in Memphis, that defined youth culture.	New Frontier	Kennedy's program of goals for education, civil rights, the Peace Corps, and space.

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Key (one defensible read)
1	Analyze the postwar economic boom, consumer culture, and the G.I. Bill's role in building the suburban middle class — and who it left out. Notice: Imagine the government hands you a deal: free college, job training, and a loan to buy a house with almost no money down. Millions of returning... Debrief: Explain how the G.I. Bill and the postwar boom built a large middle class. Then explain how and why that prosperity was unequal. Was the 1950s 'American Dream' available to all Americans? Defend your answer.	The G.I. Bill gave veterans college, training, and low-cost home loans, fueling suburbanization and a big home-owning middle class amid a booming consumer economy. It was unequal because redlining, discriminatory suburbs (e.g., Levittown), and unequal administration largely excluded Black veterans. Strong answers argue that the Dream was real but not equally available, using Marcus/redlining as evidence.
2	Analyze the baby boom and its enormous effects on the economy, schools, culture — and the women expected to make it happen. Notice: Seventy-six million babies. In less than twenty years, America had a population explosion so huge it would bend the whole country around it —... Debrief: Describe the baby boom and three ways it reshaped American society. Then explain the role women were expected to play, and why many felt a quiet discontent. How might that discontent matter later?	The baby boom (76 million births, 1946–1964) drove economic growth, forced massive school expansion, and created a huge teenage/youth market. Women were expected to be full-time homemakers raising the children. Many felt an unspoken discontent — a sense of unused potential — that would help ignite the 1960s women's movement. Strong answers connect the era's gender role to the coming push for women's rights.
3	Analyze Eisenhower's domestic achievements — the Interstate Highway System and the polio vaccine — and his moderate approach to government. Notice: A disease was paralyzing tens of thousands of American kids every year, and parents were terrified to let their children swim, or gather, or... Debrief: Describe two of Eisenhower's major domestic achievements and their benefits. Then explain one hidden cost of the interstate highways. How does this show the unit's theme of reading the 'fine print'?	Achievements: the Interstate Highway System (1956, ~41,000 miles, connecting the nation and boosting suburbs/commerce) and the polio vaccine (Salk, 1955, ending a feared disease). Hidden cost: highways were often routed through poor and Black neighborhoods, destroying homes and dividing communities, and drained downtowns. This shows the theme: a genuine achievement can carry an unequal cost for those with the least power. Strong answers name a benefit and the fine print.
4	Analyze how the automobile transformed American society — suburbs, commuting, fast food, motels, and shopping centers. Notice: A car isn't just a way to get somewhere. Give a whole country cheap cars and new highways, and watch it rebuild itself around the driver: houses... Debrief: Explain three ways the automobile transformed American society in the 1950s beyond just transportation. Then identify one long-term cost of building the country around the car.	The car enabled suburbs/commuting and spawned fast-food chains, drive-ins, motel chains (e.g., Holiday Inn), and suburban shopping centers, reorganizing daily life and making car ownership central to identity. Long-term costs include hollowed-out downtowns and deep dependence on oil (plus, with highways, divided neighborhoods). Strong answers give three transformations and a genuine cost.
5	Analyze the explosive rise of television and its impact on American culture, politics, and consumerism. Notice: In 1950, almost nobody had one. Ten years later, almost everybody did. No technology in American history had ever spread that fast or changed the... Debrief: Describe how quickly television spread in the 1950s and three ways it changed American life. Why did making 'image' powerful in politics matter for democracy?	TV rose from ~9% of homes (1950) to ~90% (1960). It reshaped family routines, created a shared national culture, supercharged advertising/consumerism, and made image central in politics. Image mattering in politics is significant because voters could be swayed by how a candidate looked/sounded rather than their positions, changing how democracy works. Strong answers give the spread, three effects, and address the political-image point.
6	Analyze the emergence of youth culture and rock 'n' roll — including Tennessee's central role and the Black roots of the music. Notice: A new sound comes screaming out of the radio, and it terrifies every parent in America — too loud, too wild, too Black, they say, for their nice... Debrief: Explain how youth culture and rock 'n' roll emerged in the 1950s, and Tennessee's central role. Then explain the deeper issue Etta raises about the Black roots of the music. Why does 'who gets the credit' matter?	Prosperous teens gained spending power and a distinct culture centered on rock 'n' roll, which grew from Black rhythm and blues rooted in Memphis (WDIA, Beale Street, B.B. King, Sun Studio); Elvis became its biggest star. Etta's issue: Black artists created the sound but often got far less fame and money than white performers who popularized it. 'Who gets the credit' matters as a question of fairness and of honestly acknowledging Black contributions to American culture. Strong answers center the Black roots.
7	Analyze Kennedy's New Frontier — education, civil rights, the Peace Corps, and the Space Race — and the optimism of the era. Notice: A young president stands up and tells a whole country to stop asking what it can get and start asking what it can give. He challenges the nation... Debrief: Describe the main goals of Kennedy's New Frontier and give two specific examples. Why is his call to the Space Race a good symbol of the era's optimism? How does the New Frontier set up the 1960s?	The New Frontier pursued education funding, civil-rights support, the Peace Corps, and winning the Space Race (Moon goal). Examples (any two): the Peace Corps sending volunteers abroad; the Moon challenge; increased education funding; federal civil-rights action. The Moon goal symbolizes the era's confidence that a free society could achieve anything 'because it is hard.' It sets up the 1960s because its goals — civil rights, service, space — became that decade's agenda (much unfulfilled at his 1963 assassination). Strong answers connect optimism to the coming decade.

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 8 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **Row upon row of nearly identical mass-produced houses in Levittown, Pennsylvania, c. 1959 — a symbol of affordable postwar suburbia and, to critics, of conformity.**

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
2. Spark's question: *This is Levittown — thousands of identical mass-produced homes. Ask: Levittown's own rules barred Black families from buying there. When you look...*
3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

Teacher note: US.71. Let the boom be real; name redlining and G.I. Bill inequities plainly via Marcus (continuity from Unit 6). TN anchor: Oak Ridge + TN suburbs and the same racial barriers.

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Historians' read (one reading, not the answer)
1944	The G.I. Bill builds a middle class	Climb Broadly regarded as a landmark investment that built the postwar middle class, though its benefits were administered unequally by race — a real...
1950	Redlining locks Black families out of the boom	Setback Widely documented as systematic housing discrimination that built a lasting racial wealth gap — an unambiguous setback for the founding promise.
1955	The polio vaccine	Climb Broadly celebrated as one of the great public-health achievements of the century.
1956	The Interstate Highway System	Climb Broadly seen as a transformative national achievement, though its urban routing later destroyed many poor and Black neighborhoods — a climb with a...
1954	Rock 'n' roll and a new youth culture	Climb Celebrated as a cultural explosion of lasting global influence, though its Black creators were often under-credited and underpaid — an advance...
1961	The New Frontier's burst of optimism	Climb Broadly seen as a hopeful expansion of national purpose, whose boldest goals inspired the decade even where unfulfilled.

B Debrief & Closing Argument

The postwar boom is the 'more perfect union' question wearing a big friendly smile. On the surface, the 1950s look like America finally delivering...

Closing question: The 1950s delivered a real, broad prosperity — and quietly left people out of it. Choose one way the postwar boom moved the country closer to its founding promise and one way it fell short, and argue whether the era, on balance, was a golden age or a golden cage. Then predict: which of its hidden discontents do you think will erupt first in the 1960s? Cite the unit — there's no answer key.

Facilitation: There is no single correct verdict — students must choose moments and defend a direction with evidence. Reward a claim that holds competing truths (opportunity *and* injustice in the same years) over a tidy one-sided answer.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now:

Answers vary; look for direct use of unit evidence and a defensible position, not a memorized "right" answer.

The Fire and the Dream

The Civil Rights Movement & the Era of Movements · 1954–1975 | Standards US.78, US.79, US.80, US.81, US.82

Archive (J. Troop)

Spark

Navigator

Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

For a century after slavery ended, America had written 'liberty and justice for all' on paper and then denied it, in law, to millions of its own people. This unit is about the generation that finally forced the country to keep its word — not by waiting, but by marching, sitting in, riding buses, and being willing to bleed for it. How does a people with almost no power move a whole nation? And once one group pries the door open, who walks through it next?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories (definitions shown).

segregation The forced separation of people by race, enforced by 'Jim Crow' laws in the South.

Brown v. Board of Education The 1954 Supreme Court case that declared school segregation unconstitutional.

nonviolent direct action Confronting injustice through peaceful protest — boycotts, sit-ins, marches — while refusing to retaliate.

sit-in A protest where activists occupy a segregated space (like a lunch counter) and refuse to leave.

Civil Rights Act of 1964 The law banning discrimination by race, color, religion, sex, or national origin.

Voting Rights Act of 1965 The law banning literacy tests and other barriers to Black voting.

Black nationalism Malcolm X's emphasis on Black pride, self-determination, and self-defense.

the movements The Native, Chicano/farmworker, and women's movements that followed the Black freedom struggle.

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Key (one defensible read)
1	Analyze Brown v. Board of Education and the fierce, sometimes violent struggle to enforce school desegregation. Notice: Nine words on a courtroom wall: 'Equal Justice Under Law.' For sixty years, the Supreme Court had said segregation was just fine — 'separate but...' Debrief: Explain what Brown v. Board of Education decided and why it mattered. Then explain why the ruling was so hard to enforce, using Little Rock or the Clinton 12 as evidence.	Brown v. Board (1954) overturned Plessy's 'separate but equal' and ruled school segregation unconstitutional — the legal foundation of the Civil Rights Movement. Enforcement was hard because of fierce, often official resistance: at Little Rock (1957) Eisenhower sent the 101st Airborne to protect the Little Rock Nine, and at Clinton, TN (1956) the Clinton 12 faced mobs and needed the National Guard. Strong answers connect the ruling to the violent struggle to enforce it.
2	Compare the different strategies civil-rights advocates used — legal challenges, nonviolence, and self-determination. Notice: You and your friends all want the same thing — justice — but you can't agree on how to get it. One says work through the courts, patiently, case... Debrief: Compare the strategies of Thurgood Marshall, Martin Luther King Jr., and Malcolm X. What could each accomplish that the others could not? Why might a movement benefit from having more than one strategy?	Marshall: legal challenges (won Brown and 29 cases) producing permanent, nationwide legal change. King: nonviolent direct action exposing segregation's brutality and winning moral/public support. Malcolm X: Black pride, self-determination, and self-defense, voicing the anger of those tired of waiting and building community power. A movement benefits from multiple strategies because they reach different audiences and pressure the nation from several directions at once. Strong answers avoid ranking one as simply 'right.'
3	Analyze how the Montgomery Bus Boycott and the student sit-ins used disciplined nonviolent action to break segregation — with Nashville as a... Notice: A tired seamstress refuses to give up her seat, and a whole city stops riding the buses for a year. College students dress in their Sunday best... Debrief: Explain how the Montgomery Bus Boycott and the sit-ins each used nonviolent tactics to fight segregation. Why did refusing to fight back make these protests so effective? What made Nashville's campaign a model?	The Montgomery Bus Boycott (1955–56) withheld Black riders' bus fares for over a year, winning a Supreme Court ruling against bus segregation. Sit-ins occupied 'whites-only' counters and refused to leave. Refusing to fight back exposed the attackers' brutality and won public sympathy while denying opponents an excuse for violence. Nashville's campaign (trained by James Lawson, led by students like Diane Nash) was a model for its discipline and success, desegregating counters by May 1960. Strong answers explain why nonviolent discipline worked.
4	Analyze how the Freedom Rides and the March on Washington used courage and mass action to force the nation to confront segregation. Notice: Get on a bus, ride it into the Deep South, and dare the mob to stop you. That's what the Freedom Riders did — Black and white activists riding... Debrief: Explain what the Freedom Rides were and how Nashville students kept them going. Then explain the significance of the March on Washington. How did facing violence actually help the movement win support?	Freedom Rides (1961): Black and white activists rode buses together to test desegregation of interstate travel; met with violence (firebombed bus near Anniston), they were saved when Nashville students (led by Diane Nash) organized replacement riders. The March on Washington (1963, 250,000+, King's 'I Have a Dream') showed massive peaceful support and pushed Congress toward the Civil Rights Act. Facing violence nonviolently exposed segregation's brutality on national television, building public and political support. Strong answers connect the violence to shifting opinion.
5	Analyze the great civil-rights laws — the Civil Rights Act of 1964 and the Voting Rights Act of 1965 — and the Selma campaign that forced them. Notice: Marches and speeches can change hearts, but only a law can change the rules. After a decade of boycotts, sit-ins, beatings, and dreams, the... Debrief: Explain how the Selma marches led to the Voting Rights Act of 1965. Then describe what the Civil Rights Act of 1964 and the Voting Rights Act of 1965 each did. Why were laws necessary, not just protests?	Selma's 'Bloody Sunday' (1965) — televised police violence against peaceful marchers — shocked the nation and built support for the Voting Rights Act. The Civil Rights Act of 1964 outlawed discrimination (race, color, religion, sex, national origin) and segregation in public accommodations; the Voting Rights Act of 1965 banned literacy tests and protected Black voting. Laws were necessary because only they could permanently change the rules and be federally enforced, beyond changing individual minds. Strong answers connect protest to legislation.
6	Analyze the movement's later phase and its cost through the 1968 Memphis sanitation strike and the assassination of Martin Luther King Jr. Notice: Two words on a sign, held by exhausted men who cleaned a city's garbage for poverty wages: 'I Am a Man.' In 1968, Memphis sanitation workers went... Debrief: Explain what the Memphis sanitation strike was about and why 'I Am a Man' captured the movement's next goal. Then explain the significance of King's assassination there. What does Memphis 1968 show about the movement's cost and its unfinished work?	The 1968 Memphis strike demanded dignity and fair pay for Black sanitation workers after two were killed by unsafe equipment; 'I Am a Man' expressed the movement's turn toward economic justice and basic human dignity beyond legal rights. King's assassination there (April 4, 1968) marked the end of the movement's classic phase and showed the deadly price of the struggle. Memphis 1968 shows both the cost paid and how much work — especially economic justice — remained. Strong answers address cost and unfinished work.
7	Analyze the related equality movements the civil-rights movement inspired — the American Indian, Chicano/farmworker, and women's movements. Notice: When one group forces a door open, others walk through it. The Black freedom movement didn't just win rights for Black Americans — it handed every... Debrief: Describe the American Indian, Chicano/farmworker, and women's movements, giving one leader or event for each. Explain how they were inspired by the Black civil-rights movement — and why each was also its own distinct struggle.	Farmworker/Chicano: Chávez and Huerta's United Farm Workers, the Delano grape strike/boycott. Women's: Betty Friedan/NOW, the 1970 Women's Strike for Equality, fighting sex discrimination. Native/AIM (1968): sovereignty and treaty rights. All borrowed civil-rights tactics (nonviolent protest, marches, boycotts) and its example. Each was also distinct because each confronted its own particular history and injustice. Strong answers show both the shared inspiration and the distinct struggles.

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 9 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **U.S. Army soldiers of the 101st Airborne escort one of the Little Rock Nine to Central High School in 1957, after the governor tried to block integration.**

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
2. Spark's question: *This is the 101st Airborne escorting one of the Little Rock Nine into school in 1957 — U.S. soldiers protecting Black teenagers from other...*
3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

Teacher note: US.78. Center the students' courage; name the official nature of the resistance. Strong TN anchor: the Clinton 12 (1956), a year before Little Rock. Marcus continuity from Units 6/8.

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Historians' read (one reading, not the answer)
1954	Brown v. Board of Education	Climb Universally regarded as a landmark advance for equality and the legal foundation of the Civil Rights Movement.
1956	The Montgomery Bus Boycott succeeds	Climb Broadly celebrated as the movement's first great mass-action victory and the launch of nonviolent direct action.
1961	The Freedom Rides face the fire	Mixed Both a moment of savage violence and a decisive show of the movement's refusal to be beaten — genuinely two-sided, so marked mixed and contested.
1964	The Civil Rights Act of 1964	Climb Broadly regarded as the most important civil-rights law since Reconstruction — a major advance toward the founding promise.
1965	The Voting Rights Act of 1965	Climb Broadly seen as a landmark securing of the right to vote and one of the most effective civil-rights laws ever passed.
1968	The assassination of Martin Luther King Jr.	Setback Universally mourned as a tragic loss that ended the movement's classic phase — an unambiguous setback.
1968	The movement inspires new movements	Climb Broadly seen as an expansion of the meaning of equality to more groups, though each movement's gains were uneven and partial — so consensus is...

B Debrief & Closing Argument

This is the unit where the 'more perfect union' stops being a hope and becomes a demand. For nine units you've watched the gap between America's...

Closing question: The civil-rights movement forced America closer to its founding promise than any moment since Reconstruction — at a terrible cost, and with the work still unfinished. Choose one victory and one thing left undone, and argue how much closer the movement brought the country to 'liberty and justice for all.' Then explain how one later movement (women's, farmworkers', or Native) built on what it started. Cite the unit — there's no answer key.

Facilitation: There is no single correct verdict — students must choose moments and defend a direction with evidence. Reward a claim that holds competing truths (opportunity *and* injustice in the same years) over a tidy one-sided answer.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now:

Answers vary; look for direct use of unit evidence and a defensible position, not a memorized "right" answer.

Toward a More Perfect Union

Modern America • 1964–Present | Standards US.83, US.84, US.85, US.86, US.87, US.88, US.89, US.90, US.91, US.92, US.93, US.94, US.95

Archive (J. Troop)

Spark

Navigator

Notetaker

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

This is the last stop, and it runs right up to your own front door. In sixty years America argued about almost everything — how big government should be, whether it could be trusted, what it owed the poor and the planet, how to keep itself safe, and who was allowed to lead. It broke a president, ended a Cold War, was attacked on its own soil, and elected a Black president in the same century a Tennessee balcony took the movement's greatest leader. After 130 years of watching the gap between America's promise and its practice, the last question is the one only you can answer: is the union still becoming more perfect — and what will you do with it?

Hold this question the whole unit. You'll answer it at the end — in your own words, from the evidence.

1 Mission Vocabulary

Write what each word means as you meet it in the stories (definitions shown).

Great Society	Johnson's 1960s programs to fight poverty and injustice, including Medicare and Medicaid.	counterculture	The 1960s youth movement that rejected mainstream values, authority, and war.
Watergate	The scandal and cover-up that forced President Nixon to resign in 1974.	stagflation	High inflation and high unemployment at the same time — the economic crisis of the 1970s.
Reaganomics	Reagan's policy of tax cuts and higher military spending to grow the economy.	War on Terror	The U.S. response to the 9/11 attacks, including wars in Afghanistan and Iraq.
the tech revolution	The shift from landlines and letters to personal computers, the internet, and smartphones.	a more perfect union	The Constitution's goal — the never-finished work of making the country live up to its promise.

2 Flight Log — every stop

One entry per landing. Jot what you *notice*, then answer the crew's debrief — the point isn't a right answer, it's your read of the evidence.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Key (one defensible read)
1	Analyze Johnson's Great Society and the 1960s counterculture as two very different responses to the question of what America should become. Notice: Two revolutions at once. In Washington, a president tries to build a 'Great Society' — declaring war on poverty itself and creating health care... Debrief: Describe two major programs of the Great Society and their goals. Then explain what the 'generation gap' and counterculture were rejecting. How were these two 1960s movements different visions of America's future?	Great Society programs: Medicare/Medicaid (health coverage for elderly/poor) and the War on Poverty (education, job training). The counterculture/generation gap rejected traditional values, materialism, authority, and the Vietnam War, embracing peace and new music. The two were different visions: the Great Society sought to improve society through government action, while the counterculture sought change by rejecting mainstream institutions and values. Strong answers contrast the two visions.
2	Analyze Nixon's 'silent majority' strategy and China opening, and the Watergate scandal that proved no one is above the law. Notice: A president pulls off one of the boldest moves in the history of American diplomacy — flying to communist China to shake the hand of a man his... Debrief: Explain Nixon's 'silent majority' strategy and his opening to China. Then explain what Watergate was and why United States v. Nixon mattered. What does Watergate teach about limits on presidential power?	The 'silent majority' strategy appealed to mainstream Americans uneasy with 1960s protest, building a conservative coalition; the 1972 China trip eased Cold War tensions. Watergate was a break-in and White House cover-up; United States v. Nixon (1974) forced release of the tapes, proving no one — not even the president — is above the law, and Nixon resigned. It teaches that constitutional checks (courts, Congress, press) can hold a president accountable. Strong answers address the limits on presidential power.
3	Analyze the rise of the modern environmental movement and its landmark laws and conflicts. Notice: A river so polluted it literally caught fire. A book that revealed the pesticides in your food were killing the birds. A neighborhood built on a... Debrief: Explain what sparked the modern environmental movement and describe two laws or agencies it created. Then explain the conflict the snail-darter case revealed. Why might environmental protection sometimes clash with other goals?	It grew from alarm over pollution, sparked by Silent Spring (1962) and the first Earth Day (1970). It created the EPA, the Clean Air Act, the Clean Water Act, and Superfund. The snail-darter case (TVA v. Hill, 1978) pitted a development project (Tellico Dam) against protecting an endangered species under the Endangered Species Act. Environmental protection can clash with goals like jobs, energy, and development, forcing hard trade-offs. Strong answers explain that tension.
4	Analyze Carter's presidency — stagflation and the energy crisis, the Camp David triumph, and the Iran Hostage Crisis. Notice: Imagine prices going up AND jobs disappearing at the same time — the two things that aren't supposed to happen together, both happening at once.... Debrief: Explain what 'stagflation' and the energy crisis were and how they affected Americans. Then contrast Carter's greatest success (Camp David) with his greatest failure (Iran). Was Carter's reputation as a 'failed' president fair? Defend your answer.	Stagflation was simultaneous high inflation and unemployment; the energy crisis brought soaring oil prices and gas lines, squeezing families. Carter's success: the Camp David Accords (1978), a historic Egypt–Israel peace. His failure: the Iran Hostage Crisis (52 Americans, 444 days), which with the economy cost him the 1980 election. Strong answers weigh the historic achievement against the crises (some beyond his control) and take a defensible position on the fairness of his reputation.
5	Analyze the Reagan Revolution — its economic policy, its social costs and conflicts, and its Cold War pressure on the Soviet Union. Notice: After a decade of gas lines, hostages, and self-doubt, a former movie actor stood up and told Americans it was 'Morning in America' again — that... Debrief: Explain 'Reaganomics' and one result of it. Describe Reagan's approach to the Cold War. Then identify one social cost or conflict of the Reagan era. Why is it important to weigh both sides of this presidency?	Reaganomics cut taxes and raised military spending; results include economic growth but a roughly tripled national debt. On the Cold War, Reagan confronted the USSR aggressively ('tear down this wall'), which supporters credit with helping end it. Costs/conflicts: the War on Drugs and mass incarceration with racial disparities, the criticized AIDS response, and rising inequality. Weighing both sides matters because this is contested, recent history where an honest account must present multiple perspectives. Strong answers give the achievements and the costs.
6	Analyze how George H.W. Bush managed the peaceful end of the Cold War and led a coalition in the Gulf War. Notice: The wall came down. The enemy America had feared for 45 years — the one with thousands of nuclear missiles aimed at your grandparents — simply... Debrief: Explain how the Cold War ended under Bush and why his restraint mattered. Then describe the Gulf War and Bush's coalition-building approach. Why was leaving Saddam Hussein in power a debated decision?	The Cold War ended peacefully (Berlin Wall fell 1989, USSR collapsed 1991); Bush's restraint mattered because gloating could have destabilized a still-nuclear USSR. The Gulf War (1991) answered Iraq's invasion of Kuwait; Bush built a broad UN-backed coalition, and Desert Storm won in 100 hours. Leaving Saddam in power was debated because it kept a hostile dictator in place — a choice questioned especially after the later Iraq War. Strong answers explain the restraint and the coalition, and the debate over stopping short.
7	Analyze the Clinton-era economy and the communication-technology revolution that reshaped how Americans live. Notice: Somewhere in the 1990s, the whole world moved into your pocket. In a single generation, America went from landlines, letters, and encyclopedias on... Debrief: Describe how communication technology changed from the 1970s to today, with two examples, including one benefit and one challenge. Then explain the Clinton-era economy and the debate over NAFTA. How did technology and the economy connect?	Technology went from landlines/letters to the PC (1981), the internet (1990s), and smartphones/social media — a benefit is connection/access; a challenge is misinformation or privacy loss. The Clinton economy boomed on the tech sector and reached the first balanced budget since 1969; NAFTA (1993) expanded free trade (supporters: bigger markets; critics: lost factory jobs). Technology and the economy connected because the internet/tech sector drove the boom. Strong answers give a benefit and a challenge and explain the connection.

#	What Spark shows you & the crew's debrief	Key (one defensible read)
8	Analyze the September 11, 2001 attacks and the War on Terror they set in motion. Notice: On an ordinary bright Tuesday morning, the country you've been studying for ten units was attacked at home — not by an army, but by nineteen men... Debrief: Explain what happened on September 11, 2001, and how the United States responded. Then explain the debate the USA PATRIOT Act raised. How does that debate connect to earlier moments in this course?	On 9/11, al-Qaeda hijacked four planes, killing nearly 3,000 people (the deadliest terrorist attack in U.S. history). The U.S. responded with the War on Terror (wars in Afghanistan and Iraq). The PATRIOT Act expanded surveillance, raising a debate over security vs. civil liberties. It connects to earlier moments like the Red Scare and Japanese American internment, when fear also tempted the country to restrict freedom. Strong answers make that historical connection.
9	Analyze the breaking of barriers for women and minorities in government, culminating in the election of the first African American president — and... Notice: Go back to Unit 1. In 1877, a Black Southerner couldn't safely vote, a woman couldn't vote at all, and the idea of either one leading the country... Debrief: Give three examples of women or minorities breaking barriers in government. Then explain why Obama's 2008 election was historic, and its context. Finally: looking across the whole course from 1877 to 2009, has the country moved closer to 'a more perfect union'? Defend your answer with evidence from at least two units.	Barrier-breakers: O'Connor (first woman on the Supreme Court), Powell/Rice (first Black Secretaries of State), Pelosi (first woman Speaker), Hillary Clinton (senator/Secretary of State/candidate). Obama's 2008 election was historic as the first African American president, amid the worst financial crisis since the Depression; he signed the ACA amid sharp partisan division. Strong answers argue a defensible position on the 130-year arc using specific evidence from at least two units (e.g., disenfranchisement in Unit 1 vs. Obama in Unit 10; the civil-rights movement's gains and its unfinished work), acknowledging both progress and what remains undone.

S Source Detective

Find this primary source in Unit 10 of your book, then work it like an investigator: **President Johnson signs Medicare and Medicaid into law in 1965 (with former President Truman beside him) — a cornerstone of the Great Society.**

1. Who made this, and when? Whose point of view does it show — and whose is missing?
2. Spark's question: *This is President Johnson signing Medicare in 1965, with former President Truman — who had tried and failed to pass health insurance — beside him....*
3. What does this source prove — and what does it *not* prove on its own?

Teacher note: US.83/84. Treat both the Great Society and counterculture fairly. Danny continuity from Units 7/8. TN anchor: Appalachian War on Poverty + Medicare/Medicaid.

A The Arc of the Union — *your call*

For each milestone, decide: did it move the country **toward** its founding promise — liberty and equality *for all* — or **away**? There's no answer key. Mark your read and back it with evidence.

Year	Milestone	Historians' read (one reading, not the answer)
1965	The Great Society builds a safety net	Climb Broadly seen as a major expansion of health and anti-poverty protection, though its size and effectiveness are debated — so consensus is marked...
1974	Watergate: the system holds	Mixed Both a vindication of constitutional checks and a lasting wound to public trust — genuinely two-sided, so marked mixed and contested.
1970	The environmental movement wins protection	Climb Broadly regarded as a major and durable advance in protecting public health and the environment.
1991	The Cold War ends peacefully	Climb Broadly celebrated as a peaceful, hopeful end to a dangerous 45-year standoff.
2001	The September 11 attacks	Setback Universally regarded as a catastrophic attack and national tragedy — an unambiguous setback.
2009	The first African American president	Climb Widely seen as a historic milestone in the long struggle for racial equality, even as the country remained sharply divided — so consensus is...

B Debrief & Closing Argument

This is where the whole course comes home. For ten units and 130 years, you've measured America against its own founding promise — 'a more perfect...

Closing question: You've now traveled the entire arc, from 1877 to today. Looking back across all ten units, argue whether the United States has, on balance, moved closer to its founding promise of 'a more perfect union' — using at least three moments from different units as evidence. Then, because this is your country now: name one part of the promise you think is still unfinished, and one thing your generation could do about it. There's no answer key. This one is yours to write.

Facilitation: There is no single correct verdict — students must choose moments and defend a direction with evidence. Reward a claim that holds competing truths (opportunity *and* injustice in the same years) over a tidy one-sided answer.

Back to the Essential Question — your answer now:

Answers vary; look for direct use of unit evidence and a defensible position, not a memorized "right" answer.